# Jane Eyre

## Out there in the world

Last part is protofeminist →women should be able to do what they want to do
Sometimes she climbs to the rooftop and imagines the busy city
A good victorian woman was not supposed to be restless
My mind's eye →faculty of imagination →romantic background →also inword ear
"Women are supposed to be very calm" →beginning of protofeminist →but they are not, because they are just like men

## Bertha Mason - page 56

Bertha belongs to two minorities: she is a woman and comes from the colony
She il locked in the attic →she is referred to in the novel as "The mad woman in the attic"
Bertha Mason is described as a villain →and is presented like an animal
Line 35 →use of irony for the description of married life →then compaers Bertha to Jane
Night of Egypt →biblical reference

Jane is:

- outspoken
- endwed with a sense of justice →she gets furious
- restless →feels the need to travel
- imaginative →when she climbs to the rooftop, she imagines what the world is really like
- active →not a passive victorian woman
- rebellious →she praises to people that are rebelling
- she is also introspective

# Recuperare 16 marzo

# The wide sargasso sea - Jean Rhys

She is a postcolonial author →and writes "The wide sargasso sea", a postcolonial novel →west indies is the carabbieans
Antoinette had a tragic childhood →her father died, she was neglected by her mother and had financial problems →but starting from 1963, the economic situation became worse because slavery was abolished →luckly she married a rich man
Bertha never speaks in the novel →she is only a crazy and animalesque woman (in Jane Eyre) →here she is beatufil
No onmiscent narrators →and the novel has 3 parts →Rochester is a vile goldigger and is not a reliable as a narrator, and Bertha too (she has mental issues)
Antoinette had burnt the Thornfield Hall
It is a prequiel and a rewriting of Jane Eyre →part three is a rewriting, the facts of the first 2 parts take place before

Her mother was a Creole, term thas has 3 meanings:

- white person of european descent, however born and raised in the colony →Antoinette is an example
- it can also be of mixed ethnicity
- creole languages are a blend of one or even two european languages and a native one

Jean Rhys was too progressive and was not appreciated
Rochester felt a sense of displancement as he was in the West Indies →while Antoinette felt displaced in England

## A disappointing colonial marriage - extract

In part two the narrator is Rochester
Rocherster is describing his newly married wife (antoinette) and describes how she talks to Caroline, a servant →he is not used to being this nice to servants
He imagines talking to his father →he says that he has accomplished something: he has married a rich girl →Rocherster was a disappointement to his father
Constant rain that is not puring = drizzle →but here the rain is intense
His british mindset finds inacceptible the close relationship between Antoinette and her servant

He also disapproves of Antoinette to be too wild →she runs in the rain to meet the servant
He describes her eyes as alien = different
In Jane Eyre Bertha is of mixed race →so there are racist remarks by some characters →here Antoinette is white, but only had european origins →she is still inferior for this reason
Antoine brought to the table 30.000 pounds as the dowry →he sees the marriage as a financial transaction →he marries her for the money
He despise both creoles and natives →Mr. Rocherster here is voulnerable, has no moral →he is not presented like an imperialistic hero

## Extract from part III

Here Antoinette is the narrator
She is an alcoholic and abuses Antoinette
Sometines Antoinette has visions →and when she was a kid, she sees her mother
When she went to England, she was locked in the attic →she thought that London was an illusion

# The stange case of Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde

## Stevenson

Stevenson was born in Scotland →in a rich respectable presbiterian family (protestant)
He lived an unconventional life →he rebelled to his background and led a life that was not common for me middle class
His parents wanted him to become a lawyer, but he became a professional writer →for which he had a less stable income
È traveled extensevly both to the continent to other places →he had to travel for health related issues →and the humid scottish environment was not suitable for him
He then left Europe and settled on the Samoa Islands on the pacific ocean
He loved living there, and got along with the native population →he doesn't have a colonial sense of superiority
He wrote some poems but is mainly know as a prose writer →he wrote short stories and novels

He wrote:

- adventure novels, like "Treasure island"
- set in scotland, like "Kidnapped"
- historical, like "" set in the middle ages
- "The strange case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr Hyde" →whose genre is not easy to define →it is both science finction, crime and psychological novel:
  - science finction too because the impossible is achieved trough science →he devided the good and part part of the human mind using powders
  - crime because crimes are committed
  - psychological →because it is an insight in the human mind
  - also epistular, because part of the novel consists of letters

There are several narrators, like Utterson, Dr. Jekyll and another one →their point of view is limited, they are not omniscent, and are not reliable mainly with Dr. Jekyll, who in his final statement might be liying to us

## Questions

### Q1

Mr Utterson was a lawyer, and was a serious and respectable gentleman →he had a long time friendship with Mr Enfield, with whom he walked around London without talking much

### Q2

One dey they witnessed something →they were walking and noticed a run-down shabby building with a colored door →at the moment Enflied told Mr Utterson "the story of the door"
Some time before he saw a primitive and beast like man who had bumped into a girl, and walked on her →the crowd got furious and obliged him to give the family a compensation →he had no cash so gave a check, signed not by Mr Hyde but by Dr Jekyll (a client and close friend of Utterson)
That event was really disturbing, for Enfield, but also for Utterson, who hears about that accident from him →it came as a shock: Jekyll was a respectable man

### Q3

Utterson took a look at the new testament made by Jekyll, according to which all his possesions would go to Mr Hyde after his death →this was strange
He decided to talk to Lanyon, another friend, who shared scientific interests like the ones of Jekyll →but they grew apart, and thought that Dr Jekyll experiments were unethical and unorthodox (same concept of Frankenstein)
Utterson decided to meet Mr Hyde in person →they met, and his first impression was negative, because Hyde was rude and ugly

### Q4

Jekyll invited Utterson for dinner, and Utterson wanted to have a word with him about Mr Hyde →Jekyll got nervous and told him to mind his own business

### Q5

One night a girl named?, who was sitting by the window, witnessed a crime →a man killed a member of the british parliament, Sir Danvers Carew, (MP) and was a brutal murder
The murder was so brutal she fainted →she then called the police, and Utterson reported Hyde →but Hyde disappeard

Dr Jekyll became social now and starting to meet his friend regularly, but after some time he started to spend most of his time in his lab again

**Q6**

One day Mr Lanyon gets sick and dies →but first he is visited by Utterson, but he doesn't want to tell him what happend →he hands him a letter, that had to be opened after Jekyll's death or disappearence

**Q7**

One night Poole, Jekyll's butler, visits him in a state of agitation →he heard strange noises coming from the lab →but the lab was locked and the servants couldn't get in So he uses an axe to open the door, and he find Mr Hyde wearing baggy clothes (as if they belonged to someone else)

**Q8**

Mr Jekyll couldn't be find, so Utterson reads a statement that Jekyll left and the letter of Lanyon →in the letter, he says that Hyde and Jekyll are the same person One day Lanyon was visited by Hyde and wanted a drug, and in front of him he drank the potion and transformed into Dr Jekyll

# The strange case of Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde - Final statement

## QA

The narrator is Jekyll, as Hyde was going to win over him →while he is still lucid, he (1) writes this statement and (2) kills himself

## QB

He talks about himself →he says that he belonged to a rich family, had good education and thinks that he is a respectable victorian gentleman
However, he says that he has passed times that are unspeakable and would not be approved by his friends and family →he did something unacceptable, but he doesn't tell precisely

## QC

He started to study the duality of the human psyche →everybody has an evil and a good side
He believes there there could be even more sides

## QD

He wanted to separate the two sides and to suppress the evil one →so that humans could only be good
Does this recall Frankenstein's purpose? →Victor wanted also to vanish diseases from humanity

## QE

He created a medicine which is the mixture of different powders

## QF

The first time he felt free from moral constricts and enjoyed the transformation into Mr Hyde →he could follow his instincts without moral
He puts an end to his life to end Hyde's life too

## QG

One night he woke up and found out that he turned into Hyde without taking the drug

# Wrap up

Not easy to define the genre →hybrid novel: science-fiction, psychological and crime
The style is realistic →it is still a Victorian novel →characters are typically victorian men living in London
There are 4 narrators →they all have limited point of views (not omniscient) and some are not reliable, for example Dr Jekyll
It is set in London →which is partly described in a realistic way, but it is also rendered as a sort of labirint →it is made of streets that create a sort of maze?
The scens tend to happen at night
The main themes are:

- the double: the protagonist has two personalities
- darwinism: it is relevant in this novel when it comes to:
  - Mr Hyde seems to be a previous stage of evolution of a human being →he looks like a primitive man
  - however Mr Hyde takes control of Dr Jekyll →so he seems to be the fittest according to Darwin's theory, and Jekyll will perish in favor of Mr Hyde

The two sides of his mind reflect two style of life: a life of respectability (Jekyll) or a free but deprived life (Hyde)
See which narrators are more relibable
Sherlock Holmes is very smart, and his ability as investigator can be seen because he can make brilliant deductions starting from clues →he has a deductive method
Utterson acts similarly and Stevenson was probabily influenced by Conan Doyle

The first english author to write about Faustus was Marlowe, who wrote about a scientist who went with the devil to have unlimited knoledge and have power other people
Faustus becomes the first over-achiever in English literature →the following over-achievers are Victor, Watson and Jekyll (who conduced immoral experiments)

This is still a Victorian novel, but is also characterized by a sharp symbolism →city of London, the house, scenes set of night = form of clear symbolism →something that the average victorian novel doesn't do (the main goal is realism)

# Oscar Wilde

## Life

He was an Irish author, but spent a lot of time in England →until he was 20 he lived in Dublin, where he was born in 1884 from a middleclass family →father doctor, mother intellectual
Both his parents were Irish independentists →they believed in Ireland independence (was a colony, and only in 1921 Ireland achieved independence)
His parents were fervant nationalists, however he had not that political commitment
He attended Ireland's most prestigious university (Trinity college) →once he had graduated, he moved to England because of studying reasons →he attended Oxford university
Here he studied greek, latin and foreign languages →after graduating from Oxford, he remained and moved in London, where he became a celebrety because of:

- his literary works
- for his lifestyle

He had an eccentric lifestyle →he was a dandy: he wore eccentric and colorful clothes, and was a sophisticated speaker →he used wit exstensevly →he was also very sensitive to beauty and art
He became so famous that he was invited to the USA (like Dickens) to hold conferences there

He got married and had two children →but he started a homosexual relationship with a young man, who belonged to one of the most powerful families in England →Lord Alfred Douglas, son of Marquis of Queensberry
When Marquis of Queensberry knew this, publicly accused Oscar Wilde of homosexuality (which was prohibited)
Wilde brought him to court and a trial for defamation started →but the marquis showed evidences and brough witnesses →so the marquis was declared not guilty, and two other trials against Wilde started →he was accused of obscene acts
In this moment, Wilde was actually at the peak of his popularity →so the trials were exstensevly covered by the english press
He was mainly a playwright
In the end he was declared guilty →this was a blow to his reputation and career (all his plays got canceled) →he was sentenced to hard labor
As he was released, he moved to Paris where he lived in poverty, and died in the year 1900

Additionally, his wife and children did not want to have anything to do with him →the two children declared that they would have joined the war to was away the shame that Oscar Wilde had brought to their family

## Works

- poetry →"The ballad of Reading Gaol (jail)" →published after his release from prison, and here he reflects on the hardship of life in prison
- prose (for which he is mainly famous) →he wrote short stories intended originally as bet times stories for his children, like "The happy prince", "The canterville Ghost" (short novel), "The picture of Dorian Gray" (only full novel), "De profundis" (which is non-fiction, it is a letter he wrote to Lord Douglas)
- plays, extremely popular →"Salomey" (biblical story, the princess who beheaded John Baptiste) →the other are society playes (they satirize the english society): "Lade Windermer's Fan", "A woman of no importance", "An ideal husband", "The importance of being earnest" →extensive use of wit and irony

## The canterville Ghost

A family came from USA →father politician and rich, mother was a phylanthropy →the Otis family, of 6 members
There are 4 children:

- eldest son, whose name is Washington (really patriotic name) →really pragmatic and almost utilitarian and materialistic
- girl Virginia, who is sensitive and empthatic instead
- two twins, having patriotic names: Star and Stripes →and they are very naughty

They moved to the UK after buying a beautiful castle which belonged to Lord Canterville, who sold the castle because it was haunted by the gost of a previous Canterville who had lived during the Reinassance
He was a ghost because he killed his wife for a very silly reason, she could not cook
The ghost tries to make the life of the family impossible, but the family is materialistic and is not successful →he gets depressed, but Virginia helps him to come to terms with his crime and fineally goes to the afterlife

# Oscar Wilde

He is considered part of an international literary movement known as "aestheticism" →it originated in France, in the mid 19th century, and then spread all around Europe
In Britain Walter Pater brought it and popularized it →he was an intellectual and was Wilde's professor at Oxford university
However, Wilde is considered the most relevant member of this movement in Britain
It is based on the principle of "Art for art's sake", according to which literature (and art in general) has got no practial purpose, and should not be produced to convey a moral message or to teach something
Art is a mere expression of beauty →art should have no moral and no political commitment →and realism does not have to be a feature
Aestheticism is not a victorian movement →victorians focused on moralism, utilitarianism and realism

Oscar Wilde is also a member of the "Decadence", which is more of a cultural atmosphere than a movement (as something that developed in a non planned way)
Decadence has two meanings:

- because of the scandal decadent writers were creating with their literary production and lifestyle →it happens with Oscar Wilde
- decadent writes were giving voice to a sense of ending for the age they were living in and for its middle-class hypocritical values →the victorian society was going to finish

## The happy prince

It was not intended for publication, it was intended as a bet time story for his children
The city is unknown, but there is a port →and there is a colossal statue of the happy prince
Questions:

1. it was beautufil and full of gold and diamonds
2. people appriciated it for its beauty and for the moral message it was conveying →one has to enjoy life
3. a little bird landed on the statue and he was flying alone, headed to Egypt
4. he had a privileged life and did not know about suffering
5. he was crying because he had to see the suffering of the people of the city

6. to become his messanger with the aim to bring parts of him to poor people
7. she was a seamstress and her son was ill, and in order to take care of him he could not work properly
8. he helps a writer, who cannot concentrate because of the cold (he is poor)
9. helps then a little girl whose eggs she was selling got broken and father would have beaten her
10. in heaven, the spirits of the bird and the prince meet in the presence of god

Moral messages are generosity, happiness comes from sharing, appearence does not matter, + religious messages →so it is not really realted to the principle of aestheticism
However there is a refernce to beauty and art, which is typical of aestheticism

## Picture of Dorian Gray

The first edition was published in the year 1890 on an American magazine (not in the UK) →it was published as a volume in the UK in 1891, together with a preface which is extremly relevant, and is considered the manifesto of british aestheticism
While the preface of the "Lyrical ballads" was the manifesto of british romanticism
Plot on page 126 →ASK NOTES ABOUT PLOT